

Getting it onto WhatsApp

What is left, in the order it makes sense to do it

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Where to pick this up. [go-live.md](#) is the full runbook with every screen and value; this is the short version of what is actually left, in the order it makes sense to do it.

Steps 1 to 3 need nobody but you. At the end of them the agent is answering on real WhatsApp, on Delta's real fleet, with Delta's real photographs, and you can hand someone a number to message.

- > **Never register your personal number with the Cloud API.** It removes that
- > number from WhatsApp on the phone, permanently, and there is no undo. Meta's
- > free test number is the development path; Delta's business number is the
- > production one.

1 — Meta app and a test number · about an hour

developers.facebook.com create an app add the **WhatsApp** product. A test number comes with it, free, able to message up to five numbers you nominate. Nominate your own.

Collect four values and put them in `.env`:

```
WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID= WHATSAPP_ACCESS_TOKEN=  
WHATSAPP_APP_SECRET= WHATSAPP_VERIFY_TOKEN= # any string you invent, used  
once
```

`go-live.md` section 2 says exactly where each one is.

2 — Let Meta reach your laptop · 15 minutes

Meta will not call `localhost`. A tunnel gives it a public HTTPS address, the same way the Stripe CLI forwarded payment events.

```
brew install cloudflared cloudflared tunnel --url http://localhost:8000
```

It prints an `https://something.trycloudflare.com` address. In the Meta dashboard, under WhatsApp Configuration Webhook, paste that address with `/webhook` on the end, paste your verify token, and subscribe to **messages**.

Then, in another window:

```
.venv/bin/python run_webhook.py
```

Message the test number from your phone. That is the moment it becomes real.

The tunnel address changes every restart. Fine for a demo, not for anything left running — see step 5.

3 — Decide the provider before showing anyone · 30 minutes

On Gemini's free tier a reply can take fifty seconds, and the quota dies partway through a day. Both were measured. Either would misrepresent an otherwise fast system in front of the person you are trying to convince.

```
RENTAL_AGENT_PROVIDER=anthropic ANTHROPIC_MODEL=claude-haiku-4-5-20251001 #  
set it; the default is Opus
```

Roughly AED 400-550 a month at their expected volume. This is also the answer to their 2-5 second requirement, so it closes two lines of their scope at once.

4 — What only Delta can do

Their WhatsApp Business number, or an invitation to their Meta Business Manager. Until then the test number is the whole demo.

The **case_update template**, requested by them in their own Business Manager, category UTILITY, body text already written in `config/rules.json` under `human_in_the_loop.reopen_template`. **Meta takes a day or two**, which is why it is worth asking for before anything else on this page.

Without it: a customer messages at 11pm, the owner answers at 9am, and WhatsApp will not let the agent deliver that answer. The reply simply never arrives.

A number for escalations — `WHATSAPP_STAFF_NUMBER` — pointed at whoever actually answers, and the hours they are reachable.

5 — When it stops being a demo

A tunnel from a laptop is not where this runs. Railway, Render or Fly each give you a Postgres on the same network:

- Set `DATABASE_URL` to the hosted database. That is the entire migration.
- Set `FLEET_REFRESH=1` so the nightly re-import runs on a machine that stays awake.
- On any database that already exists, the columns added since it was created:

```
ALTER TABLE quotes ALTER COLUMN deposit DROP NOT NULL; ALTER TABLE reservations  
ALTER COLUMN deposit DROP NOT NULL; ALTER TABLE conversations ADD COLUMN IF NOT  
EXISTS sales_outcome VARCHAR;
```

A brand new database needs none of this — `create_all` builds it correctly.

- Point Meta's webhook at the deployed URL instead of the tunnel.
- **The hosting account should be Delta's.** It will hold their customers' names, numbers and complete conversation histories.

6 — Before a real customer

The checklist in `go-live.md` section 8. The two that matter most:

- **The demo footer off and the real fleet on, together.** A real booking still carrying "this is a demonstration" looks broken; fictional data without it is a fake booking presented as real. `Operator.is_demonstration` is the single switch.
- `WHATSAPP_STAFF_NUMBER` **pointed at a person**, not a placeholder.

Things that are not on this list, and why

Hosting the photographs. Not needed. All 336 images in `config/fleet.json` are absolute URLs on Delta's own server, and Meta fetches image URLs itself, so their pictures stay where they already live. `WHATSAPP_MEDIA_BASE_URL` matters only for the fictional demo fleet.

Payment links. Done and verified end to end. `PAYMENT_PROVIDER=stripe` with a `sk_test_` key gives real Checkout pages; `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` plus `stripe listen --forward-to localhost:8000/payments/stripe` records the payment when it arrives.

Availability. Still nobody's to solve but Delta's. Until there is a source to read, a booking is a hold and one tap from the owner confirms it.